

HEALING FOR THE HOMES SERIES

WHY HAVE YOU LEFT ME, *Holy Spirit?*

Restore Your Presence.

Revive My Soul.

— PSALM 51:11



Overcomers
Global Network
EDUCATE . EQUIP . EVOLVE

BY PROPHET JOSHUA MATTHEWS

DEDICATION

This booklet is dedicated to every believer who has ever felt the silence of heaven — the one who once felt God's presence so close it was like breath on your skin, and now feels nothing but stillness. You are not forgotten. You are not forsaken. The Spirit of God is closer than you know, and He is about to speak again.

A MESSAGE FROM THE FOUNDER

Dear friend,

I know what it feels like to cry out to God and hear nothing in return. I know what it's like to sit in a room full of worshippers and feel completely alone — like the connection you once had with the Holy Spirit has been unplugged. I have been there. In some of the deepest seasons of my ministry, I wondered if God had moved on from me.

But I want to tell you something from the depths of my spirit: He has not left you. The silence you feel is not His absence — it is often His invitation to go deeper. I wrote this booklet because I believe the Holy Spirit led me to reach into the place where you are sitting right now — that quiet, aching place — and remind you that you are still His.

Read slowly. Pray as you read. Let the Word do what only the Word can do. He is here. Right now. With you.

With all my love in Christ,

Joshua Matthews

Founder, Overcomers Global Network

The Cry of the Soul

There is a kind of loneliness that no human being can fix. It is not the loneliness of being without people — it is the loneliness of being without His presence. And if you are reading this, you may know exactly what I am talking about.

You remember what it used to feel like. You remember when worship would bring you to tears — not tears of sadness, but tears of being so overwhelmed by God's love that your body couldn't contain it. You remember the moments when the Holy Spirit would whisper to your heart during prayer, and you just *knew* it was Him. You could feel Him like warmth in a cold room.

And then something changed.

Maybe it was gradual — like a tide pulling away from shore so slowly you didn't notice until the sand was dry. Or maybe it was sudden — a crisis, a sin, a season of pain that seemed to slam the door between you and God.

Now you sit in the same chair where you used to meet Him, and nothing happens. You open your Bible and the words feel flat. You lift your hands in worship and your arms feel heavy. You try to pray and the ceiling feels like concrete.

And the question rises from the deepest part of your spirit:

"Holy Spirit... why have You left me?"

Child of God, I hear your cry. And more importantly, *He* hears your cry.

Before we go any further, I need you to hear this: the very fact that you are grieving the absence of the Holy Spirit is proof that He has not left you. A person who has no relationship with God does not miss God. A heart that is dead to the Spirit does not ache for the Spirit. Your pain is evidence of connection — not disconnection.

Think about it this way. When you lose a loved one, the grief you feel is directly proportional to the love you had. You cannot grieve someone you never knew. In the same manner, you cannot mourn the Holy Spirit's presence if He was never truly with you. The ache in your chest is actually the fingerprint of your relationship with Him — and it is still alive.

Psychologists recognize something called "attachment grief" — the deep emotional response we have when a bond we depend on seems threatened or broken. Studies show that this kind of grief affects not just the emotions but the physical body: sleep is disrupted, appetite changes, the chest physically tightens, and the mind struggles to concentrate. Sound familiar?

Many believers experience these exact symptoms during seasons of spiritual dryness and mistake them for depression or emotional weakness. But I want you to see them for what they truly are — the cry of a spirit that was designed for communion with God and is desperate to return to it.

""As the deer pants for the water brooks, so pants my soul for You, O God. My soul thirsts for God, for the living God. When shall I come and appear before God? My tears have been my food day and night, while they continually say to me, 'Where is your God?'"

— Psalm 42:1–3 (NKJV)

David wrote those words from a place of raw, unfiltered pain. And God put them in the Bible. That means your cry is not a sign of failure — it is a prayer that heaven honors.

What the Bible Says

Let me show you something that will change the way you see this season forever. The Bible is filled with men and women who experienced exactly what you are feeling — and not one of them was abandoned by God.

""For He Himself has said, 'I will never leave you nor forsake you.'""

— Hebrews 13:5 (NKJV)

That is not a suggestion. That is not a hopeful wish. That is a covenant promise from the mouth of the Almighty God. He does not break His word. He *cannot* break His word. When He says "never," He means never — not sometimes, not usually, not when you deserve it. Never.

Jesus Himself promised the permanent presence of the Holy Spirit to every believer:

""And I will pray the Father, and He will give you another Helper, that He may abide with you forever — the Spirit of truth, whom the world cannot receive, because it neither sees Him nor knows Him; but you know Him, for He dwells with you and will be in you. I will not leave you orphans; I will come to you.""

— John 14:16–18 (NKJV)

Did you catch that? *"That He may abide with you forever."* The word "forever" in the Greek is *eis ton aiona* — meaning into the age, without end. Jesus did not send the Holy Spirit for a season. He sent Him for eternity. And then He added those five words that should shatter every fear in your heart: **"I will not leave you orphans."**

You are not an orphan. You have a Father. You have a Comforter. And He is still in the room with you, even when you cannot feel Him.

Consider Elijah the prophet. This was a man who called fire down from heaven, who defeated 450 prophets of Baal, who heard the voice of God and obeyed with power and boldness. And yet, just one chapter later in Scripture, we find him sitting under a tree, depressed, exhausted, and begging God to let him die:

""But he himself went a day's journey into the wilderness, and came and sat down under a broom tree. And he prayed that he might die, and said, 'It is enough! Now, Lord, take my life, for I am no better than my fathers!'"

— 1 Kings 19:4 (NKJV)

This is one of the mightiest prophets in all of Scripture — and he felt exactly what you are feeling. He felt depleted. He felt alone. He felt like the anointing had drained out of him.

But what did God do? God did not rebuke him. God did not lecture him. God sent an angel to feed him, let him rest, and then spoke to him — not in the wind, not in the earthquake, not in the fire — but in *a still small voice* (1 Kings 19:12).

This is critical for you to understand: sometimes God changes the way He speaks to us, not because He has gone silent, but because He wants us to listen differently. If you have been waiting for the fire and the earthquake — the dramatic encounters and overwhelming emotions — maybe God is inviting you into the still, small voice. Maybe He is saying, "Come closer. Be quiet. I want to whisper something to you that only intimacy can hear."

In my own life, I learned this the hard way. There were seasons when I chased the feelings — the goosebumps, the tears, the electricity of worship — and when they faded, I panicked. But the Lord taught me that feelings are not the measurement of His presence. *Faith* is. As it is written:

""For we walk by faith, not by sight.""

— 2 Corinthians 5:7 (NKJV)

The Root of the Pain

Now, let me speak to you honestly. There are real reasons why a believer may feel distant from the Holy Spirit, and we need to examine them — not to condemn you, but to heal you. A good doctor does not just treat symptoms; he looks for the root.

Unconfessed Sin. I say this gently, because shame is a weapon the enemy uses to keep us away from God. But the truth is, when we harbor sin in our hearts and refuse to bring it to the light, it creates a wall — not because God has turned away, but because we have turned away. The prophet Isaiah wrote:

""Behold, the Lord's hand is not shortened, that it cannot save; nor His ear heavy, that it cannot hear. But your iniquities have separated you from your God; and your sins have hidden His face from you, so that He will not

hear.""

— Isaiah 59:1–2 (NKJV)

But notice — it is not God's ability that has changed. His hand is not shortened. His ear is not heavy. It is sin that creates the barrier. And the beautiful thing about confession is that it destroys that barrier instantly:

""If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.""

— 1 John 1:9 (NKJV)

Child of God, if there is something you have been carrying in the dark, bring it to Him right now. He will not crush you. He will cleanse you.

Emotional Exhaustion and Burnout. This is a reality that the church does not talk about enough. Many believers burn out — serving, giving, pouring into others, carrying burdens that were never theirs to carry — until they have nothing left. And when the tank is empty, the Spirit's voice becomes harder to hear. Not because He is silent, but because you are too exhausted to listen.

Medical research shows that prolonged emotional stress triggers a state called "allostatic overload," where the body's stress-response systems become so overtaxed that the brain's ability to process emotion, focus, and even experience pleasure is significantly diminished. When a believer enters this state, worship feels flat, prayer feels pointless, and the presence of God feels far away — but it is a physiological condition, not a spiritual verdict.

God understands your body. He made it. Remember how He treated Elijah in his exhaustion? He did not hand him a sermon — He gave him *food and sleep* (1 Kings 19:5–7). Sometimes the most spiritual thing you can do is rest.

Trauma and Emotional Wounding. If you have experienced deep hurt — betrayal, abuse, loss, rejection — those wounds can create a protective wall around your heart. Psychologically, this is called an "emotional defense mechanism." Your heart, in an effort to protect itself from further

pain, shuts down its ability to feel deeply — and the Holy Spirit often speaks through the deep places of the heart.

This does not mean you are broken beyond repair. It means you need healing, and that is exactly what Christ came to give you:

""The Spirit of the Lord God is upon Me, because the Lord has anointed Me to preach good tidings to the poor; He has sent Me to heal the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to those who are bound.""

— **Isaiah 61:1 (NKJV)**

Spiritual Attack. I would be dishonest if I did not mention this. The enemy of your soul knows that your greatest weapon is your relationship with the Holy Spirit. And he will do everything in his power to make you believe that relationship is over.

He whispers lies: "God is done with you." "You've gone too far." "You've grieved the Spirit and He won't come back." "Other people can hear God, but not you anymore." These are lies from the pit of hell. And you must recognize them as such.

""The thief does not come except to steal, and to kill, and to destroy. I have come that they may have life, and that they may have it more abundantly.""

— **John 10:10 (NKJV)**

The enemy wants to steal your intimacy with God. He wants to kill your prayer life. He wants to destroy your confidence in the Holy Spirit. But Jesus came to give you life — abundant, overflowing, unshakable life.

Spiritual Growth Through Silence. And here is something many people do not expect to hear: sometimes God allows seasons of silence as part of your spiritual maturation. Just as a parent must eventually let a child walk without holding their hand — not because they have abandoned the child, but because the child is ready for a new level — God sometimes withdraws the *feeling* of His presence to strengthen the *foundation* of your faith.

The great saints of the faith have written about this. Saint John of the Cross called it "the dark night of the soul." It is not punishment. It is promotion. God is not pushing you away — He is pulling you into a deeper dimension of trust where your relationship with Him is no longer dependent on feelings but on His unchanging Word.

Christ's Healing Power

I want to take you somewhere right now. I want you to close your eyes for a moment — wherever you are — and let me paint a picture for you.

Imagine a room. It is dark. You have been sitting in it for a long time — so long that your eyes have adjusted to the darkness and you have forgotten what light looks like. You have stopped reaching for the door. You have stopped believing there even is a door.

But then you hear it. A sound. Soft. Gentle. Like a hand knocking on wood. And a voice — warm and familiar, like someone you loved before you could remember — says:

"Behold, I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears My voice and opens the door, I will come in to him and dine with him, and he with Me."

— Revelation 3:20 (NKJV)

That is Jesus speaking to you. Not to the unsaved. Not to strangers. He is speaking to the *church* — to believers who have lost their sense of His nearness. And He is not angry. He is not walking away. He is knocking. He is waiting. He is asking to be let back into the place where you stopped inviting Him.

The healing begins when you open that door. Not with perfect words. Not with perfect faith. Just with honesty. Just say, "Lord, I don't feel You, but I believe You are here. Come back into this place. Sit with me. Speak to me. I'm listening."

When I was going through my own season of spiritual dryness, I did not have eloquent prayers. I remember one night lying face down on the floor and saying only three words: "God, help me." And He did. Not with fireworks. Not with an audible voice. But with a peace that settled into my chest like warm water — and I knew He was there. He had always been there.

""Come to Me, all you who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me, for I am gentle and lowly in heart, and you will find rest for your souls.""

— **Matthew 11:28–29 (NKJV)**

He says "come." Not "perform." Not "prove yourself." Not "wait until you're worthy." Come. Come as you are. Come with your doubts. Come with your emptiness. Come with your tears.

The Holy Spirit is not a force that comes and goes like the wind. He is a *Person* — the third Person of the Trinity — and He has committed Himself to you. He sealed you. Paul wrote:

""In Him you also trusted, after you heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation; in whom also, having believed, you were sealed with the Holy Spirit of promise, who is the guarantee of our inheritance until the redemption of the purchased possession, to the praise of His glory.""

— **Ephesians 1:13–14 (NKJV)**

You are *sealed*. That word in the Greek is *sphragiz*■ — it means to stamp with a signet ring, to mark as owned, to secure. In the ancient world, a king's seal on a document meant it could not be opened or reversed by anyone but the king himself. The Holy Spirit has placed God's seal on your life. No devil, no sin, no season of dryness can break that seal.

Let that truth sink into you right now. Say it out loud if you need to: "I am sealed by the Holy Spirit. He has not left me. He will never leave me."

Healing is happening as you read these words. The Spirit of the living God is hovering over the pain in your heart — the same Spirit that hovered over the waters in Genesis 1:2 and brought order out of chaos. He is

bringing order to your soul right now. Let Him.

Healing Prayers

A Prayer for Restored Fellowship

Holy Spirit, I come to You with an open heart and empty hands. I have nothing to offer You but my honesty. I have felt Your absence, and it has broken me. But I choose to believe Your Word over my feelings. You said You would never leave me, and I trust that promise today. Forgive me for the times I shut You out — through sin, through distraction, through busyness, through fear. Forgive me for blaming You for a silence that may have been my own. I repent, Lord. I turn my heart back to You right now. Come and fill this room. Come and fill my spirit. Let me hear Your voice again. Let me feel Your warmth again. Let me know You the way I used to — and deeper than I ever have. Restore me, Holy Spirit. Renew me. In Jesus' name, amen.

A Prayer Against Spiritual Attack

Father, in the name of Jesus Christ, I take authority over every lying spirit that has tried to convince me that You are gone. I rebuke the spirit of abandonment. I rebuke the spirit of confusion. I rebuke the spirit of heaviness and despair. Your Word says that no weapon formed against me shall prosper, and every tongue that rises against me in judgment, I shall condemn (Isaiah 54:17). I condemn every lie the enemy has spoken over my prayer life, my worship, and my relationship with the Holy Spirit. I declare that the Holy Spirit is alive in me. I declare that I am not forgotten. I declare that the same Spirit who raised Christ from the dead dwells in me (Romans 8:11). Devil, you are a liar and the father of lies, and I reject every word you have spoken over my life. In Jesus' mighty name, amen.

A Prayer for Emotional Healing

Lord Jesus, You know the wounds I carry. You know the exhaustion in my soul. You know the trauma that built walls around my heart — walls I

didn't even know were there. I ask You to come into the broken places. Touch the parts of me that I've protected from everyone, including You. I don't want to hide anymore. I don't want to be numb anymore. I want to feel Your presence again, even if it means feeling the pain first. Heal my mind. Heal my emotions. Heal my memories. Let Your blood wash over every wound, every scar, every place where the enemy planted shame and fear. I receive Your healing right now. I receive the oil of joy for mourning. I receive the garment of praise for the spirit of heaviness (Isaiah 61:3). I am Yours, Lord. All of me. Even the broken parts. Especially the broken parts. In Jesus' name, amen.

A Prayer for Fresh Fire

Holy Spirit, I ask You for fresh fire. Not just the feeling of fire — but the reality of Your power in my life. I want to walk in the authority You gave me. I want to hear Your voice with clarity. I want to see visions and dream dreams. I want the gifts You placed inside me to come alive again. Baptize me afresh. Let the fire fall on me like it fell at Pentecost. Let my tongue be loosed to pray in the Spirit. Let my eyes be opened to see in the Spirit. Let my heart be softened to love as You love. I will not settle for a memory of what we had. I want more of You than I have ever had before. Pour out, Holy Spirit. I am ready. In the mighty name of Jesus Christ, amen.

Prophetic Declarations

Stand where you are, lift your voice, and declare these words over your life. These are not empty phrases — they are rooted in the Word of God, and when you speak them in faith, heaven moves on your behalf.

"The Holy Spirit lives in me, and He will never leave me."

"I am sealed by the Spirit of God. My identity is secure."

"No season of silence can separate me from God's love."

"I reject every lie that says God is finished with me."

"My prayer life is being restored right now, in Jesus' name."

"I will hear God's voice again. I will feel His presence again."

"The fire of the Holy Spirit is not extinguished — it is being rekindled."

"I am not an orphan. I have a Father who loves me and a Comforter who stays."

"My worship will break through the heaviness. My praise will shatter the silence."

"This season of dryness is ending today. Fresh rain is coming to my spirit."

"I decree and declare: the Holy Spirit is moving in my life again."

"What the enemy tried to steal, God is restoring sevenfold."

""So I say to you, ask, and it will be given to you; seek, and you will find; knock, and it will be opened to you. For everyone who asks receives, and he who seeks finds, and to him who knocks it will be opened.""

— Luke 11:9–10 (NKJV)

Reflection & Healing

Take a few quiet moments with these questions. Do not rush. Let the Holy Spirit guide your thoughts as you reflect honestly. If you have a journal, write your answers. This is between you and God.

Reflect on These Questions

1. When was the last time you clearly felt the presence of the Holy Spirit? What was happening in your life at that time?
2. What changed between then and now? Was it a specific event, a season of busyness, a sin, or a gradual drift?
3. Have you been carrying unforgiveness, shame, or unconfessed sin? Are you willing to lay it down today?

4. Have you been measuring God's presence by your feelings, or by His Word? What would it look like to trust His promise even when you cannot feel Him?

5. What is one thing you can do this week to create space for the Holy Spirit — even if it's just five minutes of silence with no phone, no music, no distractions?

6. If the Holy Spirit were sitting beside you right now, what would you say to Him? Write it down. He is listening.

Dear reader, you have reached the end of this booklet, but you have not reached the end of your journey with the Holy Spirit. In many ways, this is a new beginning. God is faithful, and He finishes what He starts:

""Being confident of this very thing, that He who has begun a good work in you will complete it until the day of Jesus Christ.""

— **Philippians 1:6 (NKJV)**

He started something in you. And He is not done. Not even close.

A CLOSING PRAYER

Father God, I thank You for the one holding this booklet right now. You know their name. You know their tears. You know every night they've spent wondering if You were still there.

Lord, I ask You — right now, in the mighty name of Jesus Christ — pour out Your Holy Spirit afresh upon them. Let them feel Your warmth again. Let them hear Your voice again. Let them know, deep in their bones, that You never left and You never will.

Restore their joy. Restore their worship. Restore their fellowship with You. Let tonight be the night that everything changes. In Jesus' name, amen.

AN INVITATION TO CHRIST

If you have never given your life to Jesus Christ, or if you've walked away and want to come back home, simply pray: "Lord Jesus, I confess that I am a sinner. I believe You died for me and rose again. I surrender my life to You today. Fill me with Your Holy Spirit and make me new. I receive You as my Lord and Savior. In Jesus' name, amen." If you prayed that prayer, welcome to the family of God. You are now a child of the King.

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WHY HAVE YOU LEFT ME, *Holy Spirit?*

Have you ever felt far from God and empty in spirit? This booklet was written for the soul that longs again for the presence of the Holy Spirit. Through scripture, prayer, and healing truth, Joshua Matthews gently leads you from spiritual dryness to renewed intimacy with God. If your heart is crying out for His presence, these pages were written for you.

Let the Lord restore your heart
and draw you near again.



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